

Vocabulary from Indigenous, Minority, and Local Languages

Countries covered: Brunei, Cambodia, Indonesia, Laos, Malaysia, Myanmar, the Philippines, Singapore, Thailand, Vietnam, and Timor-Leste.

Note: This is a starter vocabulary list using romanized words. Some entries are from national or local languages rather than legally defined Indigenous languages. For formal research, verify spellings and meanings with native speakers or academic sources.

Suggested use: This table can be used as a basic reference for a school assignment or as a starting point for deeper research into language preservation.

Country	Language	Where it comes from	English	Vocabulary word
Brunei	Iban	Brunei; also Sarawak, Malaysia and Kalimantan, Indonesia	Thank you	Terima kasih
Brunei	Iban	Brunei / Borneo	Mother	Indai
Brunei	Iban	Brunei / Borneo	Father	Apai
Brunei	Iban	Brunei / Borneo	Water	Ai
Cambodia	Khmer	Cambodia	Hello	Suosdei
Cambodia	Khmer	Cambodia	Thank you	Arkoun
Cambodia	Khmer	Cambodia	Water	Teuk
Cambodia	Khmer	Cambodia	Mother	Mday / Mak
Indonesia	Balinese	Bali, Indonesia	Thank you	Suksma / Matur suksma
Indonesia	Balinese	Bali, Indonesia	Water	Yeh
Indonesia	Balinese	Bali, Indonesia	Father	Bapa / Aji
Indonesia	Balinese	Bali, Indonesia	Mother	Meme
Laos	Lao	Laos	Hello	Sabaidee
Laos	Lao	Laos	Thank you	Khop chai
Laos	Lao	Laos	Water	Nam
Laos	Lao	Laos	Mother	Mae
Malaysia	Iban	Sarawak, Malaysia	Mother	Indai
Malaysia	Iban	Sarawak, Malaysia	Father	Apai
Malaysia	Iban	Sarawak, Malaysia	Water	Ai
Malaysia	Iban	Sarawak, Malaysia	Food	Pemakai

Country	Language	Where it comes from	English	Vocabulary word
Myanmar	Burmese	Myanmar	Hello	Mingalaba
Myanmar	Burmese	Myanmar	Thank you	Jezu tin ba de
Myanmar	Burmese	Myanmar	Mother	Amay
Myanmar	Burmese	Myanmar	Father	Aphay
Philippines	Tagalog	Philippines	Hello / How are you?	Kumusta
Philippines	Tagalog	Philippines	Thank you	Salamat
Philippines	Tagalog	Philippines	Water	Tubig
Philippines	Tagalog	Philippines	Mother	Ina / Nanay
Singapore	Malay	Malay community in Singapore	Thank you	Terima kasih
Singapore	Malay	Singapore / Malay Peninsula	Water	Air
Singapore	Malay	Singapore / Malay Peninsula	Mother	Ibu
Singapore	Malay	Singapore / Malay Peninsula	Father	Bapa
Thailand	Thai	Thailand	Hello	Sawatdee
Thailand	Thai	Thailand	Thank you	Khop khun
Thailand	Thai	Thailand	Water	Nam
Thailand	Thai	Thailand	Mother	Mae
Vietnam	Hmong Daw / White Hmong	Northern Vietnam; also Laos and China	Hello	Nyob zoo
Vietnam	Hmong Daw / White Hmong	Northern Vietnam	Thank you	Ua tsaug
Vietnam	Hmong Daw / White Hmong	Northern Vietnam	Mother	Niam
Vietnam	Hmong Daw / White Hmong	Northern Vietnam	Father	Txiv
Timor-Leste	Tetum	Timor-Leste	Hello / Good morning	Bondia
Timor-Leste	Tetum	Timor-Leste	Thank you	Obrigadu / Obrigada
Timor-Leste	Tetum	Timor-Leste	Water	Bee
Timor-Leste	Tetum	Timor-Leste	Mother	Inan
Timor-Leste	Tetum	Timor-Leste	Father	Aman